Texas College of Management & IT

Bachelor of Information Technology (BIT)

Assignment Title: Social values and Ethics: multi chapter overview

Subject: Social Values and Ethics in Profession
Instructor: [Insert Name]
Academic Year: 3rd Year / 6th Semester

Assignment Guidelines:

- This assignment is to be completed individually.
- Submissions must be in formal academic language and adhere to the prescribed format.
- Referencing Style: Use APA/ IEEE citation style for any references.
- Any form of plagiarism or academic dishonesty will result in a penalty.
- Submit your work in PDF format (maximum size: 25 MB).
- File Name: YourName_DigitalEthicsPortfolio.pdf
- Adherence to the deadline is mandatory:

Assignment Purpose, Learning Outcomes, and Objectives:

Assignment Purpose:
The purpose of this assignment is to engage students in analyzing the ethical, legal, and societal impacts of digital technologies. Through multi-chapter activities and critical reflections, students will explore professional responsibilities and ethical frameworks necessary for operating in a digitally connected world.

Expected Learning Outcomes (LOs):

- Analyze how rapid technological change shapes society, law, and business.
- Apply core ethical theories to real-world professional dilemmas.
- Evaluate privacy practices, IP disputes, networked-communication risks, and cyber-law regimes.
- Design public-awareness media and policy artefacts that promote responsible digital behavior.
- Demonstrate security-governance leadership through frameworks, executive briefs, and policies.

Assignment Objectives:

- Strengthen ethical reasoning and digital governance understanding

- Identify and mitigate cyber risks through structured frameworks
- Reflect on privacy, bias, and digital rights challenges
- Promote equity and inclusion in tech-enabled professional environments

Assignment Tasks

Chapter 1: Catalyst for Change [10 Marks]

1. **Question:**

   Describe how human society has evolved from early civilization to the digital age. How have major technological changes—such as agriculture, industry, electricity, and digital tools—shaped our culture, economy, and daily life? Discuss the positive transformations and ethical challenges of modern technologies like the internet, smartphones, and artificial intelligence.

2. **Case Study [10 Marks]**

Question 2:

Title: Rejected by a Black-Box: Nicolette's HireVue Interview

Background

Nicolette Vartuli, a senior with a 3.5 GPA, applies to Barkley-Sturbridge Capital. Instead of a human interview, she records a 20-minute video on HireVue. The software, trained on videos of the bank's top performers, analyzes her facial expressions, tone, and word choice, then issues a single score. Nicolette receives an auto-email: "You will not advance." No reason is given; HireVue keeps her video for "future product improvement."

Key facts:

1. Opaque Criteria: Neither Nicolette nor BSC knows which features drove the rejection; the model is proprietary.
2. Data Retention: HireVue stores raw videos three years, potentially using them to train other clients' models.
3. Possible Bias: External audits have shown higher false-reject rates for women and non-native speakers on similar systems.

4. Legal Gray Zone: U.S. law offers limited applicant rights compared with the EU's GDPR "right to explanation."
5. Power Imbalance: Opting-out means losing the job chance; appealing is impossible.

Questions:

I. Privacy Focus
Identify two specific privacy interests at stake (e.g., biometric data, behavioral data). What technical or policy safeguard would best protect each?

II. Transparency vs. Trade Secret
Should companies like HireVue be legally required to reveal how their models score applicants? Give one argument for and one against, citing an existing law or principle.

III. Bias Check
Design a simple test to detect whether HireVue's model disproportionately rejects a demographic group. What data would you need and what result would signal bias?

IV. Data Retention
Is keeping rejected applicants' videos for three years justified? Compare this practice to the GDPR principle of "purpose limitation" and state whether you find it acceptable.

V. Human vs. Machine Judgment
Nicolette feels an unexplained algorithm is less fair than a possibly biased human interviewer. Do you agree? Defend your view in 3–4 sentences, referencing concepts of explainability and trust.

Chapter: 2 Introduction To Ethics [Marks :10]

3. **Case Study: Whistleblower in a Tech Company – Ethics vs. Loyalty**

Background:
Ravi, a software engineer working in a well-known multinational tech company, discovers that the company is secretly collecting and selling user data without users'

consent. This action violates the company's own privacy policies and potentially breaches data protection laws. Ravi raises the concern with his manager, but he is told to "stay quiet and stay loyal." He is warned that speaking up could jeopardize his career.

Ravi is now faced with a difficult ethical decision. If he reports this wrongdoing (blows the whistle), he may lose his job, face legal risks, and damage his reputation. However, staying silent would mean allowing unethical and possibly illegal practices to continue, putting millions of users' privacy at risk.

He begins reflecting on various ethical theories he studied—utilitarianism, deontology, egoism, and social contract theory—to guide his decision. He also faces personal moral questions: Does loyalty to his employer override his duty to the public? Is it selfish to protect his own job at the cost of the truth?

Questions

a) Apply two ethical theories (e.g., Utilitarianism and Kantianism) to Ravi's situation. How would each theory guide him to act? Which approach do you think is more ethical in this scenario?

b) Discuss the conflict between professional loyalty and moral responsibility. Should Ravi prioritize his loyalty to the company or the public's right to privacy? Justify your reasoning.

c) Evaluate Ravi's dilemma using the Social Contract Theory. What responsibilities does he have as a member of society versus as an employee?

d) Do you think Ravi would be justified in blowing the whistle? Explain your answer considering consequences, legal implications, and ethical duties.

e) How can organizations create a culture where ethical concerns are taken seriously without fear of punishment? Suggest policies or practices that support ethical behavior and protect whistleblowers.

Chapter 3 Privacy [Marks :10]

Note: Insert a screenshot of every action while doing this assignment.

4. **Activity-Based Assignment**

Title: ***Privacy Audit of Your Digital Life***

Instructions:

- **List 5 apps or services you use.**
- **Check and describe their privacy settings.**
- **Note what data they collect from you.**
- **Suggest at least 3 actions you could take to better protect your privacy.**

Chapter 4: Intellectual Property [Marks: 10]

5. Assignment Tasks: Case Study Analysis (Written Report, 600-800 words)

   Choose a real-world example (can be a company, product, software, or media content) that involves issues related to intellectual property. Your case should highlight at least three of the following:

- Use of trade secrets
- Filing or dispute over patents
- Application of copyright
- Challenges or considerations of fair use
- Issues related to peer-to-peer (P2P) sharing or protection
- Use or development of open-source software or content

  In your report, include:

  a) Background of the case and the IP issues involved.
  b) Explanation of how the company or individuals managed or contested these IP rights.
  c) The impact of these IP issues on innovation, competition, or creativity.
  d) Your critical opinion on how well the IP protections balanced creators' rights and public interest.

Chapter 5: Networked Communications [Marks: 15]

6. **Assignment Title: Public Awareness Design & Reflection Objective:**

To raise public awareness on key digital issues through the creation of a visually engaging flyer or social media banner, and to reflect on the importance of responsible online behavior.

Instructions:

Create a public awareness flyer or social media banner on **one of the following topics:**

Topics

a) Email and Spam

b) Censorship and Freedom of Expression

c) Children and Inappropriate Content / Trust on the Internet

d) Internet Addiction

Guidelines for the Flyer/Banner:

1. Use short, powerful slogans and eye-catching visuals.
2. Highlight key facts, risks, or safety tips related to your topic.
3. Your design should be original, creative, and socially impactful.
4. You may use any free design tool such as Canva, PowerPoint, Photoshop, or online editors.
5. Keep the message clear and audience-friendly (aimed at the general public, students, or parents).

Social Media Task:

1. Post your flyer/banner on your social media account (e.g., Facebook, Instagram, or Twitter).
2. Use an appropriate caption and hashtags to raise awareness. *(Example: "Protect your data. Think before you click! #CyberSafety #SayNoToSpam")*
3. Take a screenshot of your post and insert it into your assignment report.

Chapter 6: Cyber Law [Marks : 10]

7. **Question**

Critically analyze how modern cyber laws—including constitutional foundations, intellectual property rights, privacy, and data protection—work together to address cybersecurity challenges in the digital age. Support your answer with recent examples or case studies.

Chapter 7 : Cyber Ethics [Marks: 10]

8. **Case Study: "The Hiring Dilemma at TechNova Solutions"**

Background:

TechNova Solutions is a growing software development company known for its innovative products and client-focused services. Recently, the company advertised a senior developer position. Among the applicants were:

- Aarti, a highly experienced programmer with a strong portfolio, who is wheelchair-bound and requires some workplace accommodations.
- Ravi, a recent graduate from a prestigious university, confident but with little experience.
- Sarah, who identifies as non-binary and has a good mix of skills and teamwork experience.
- Manish, who has worked in the company for 5 years and is applying for promotion but has had mixed performance reviews.

During the selection meeting, the hiring manager subtly suggested not hiring Aarti due to "mobility concerns" and expressed discomfort about how Sarah's gender identity might affect team dynamics. Other panel members remained silent, although they privately disagreed. Eventually, the team selected Ravi due to his "energy and fresh outlook," even though Aarti scored the highest in the technical assessment.

Topics Involved:

- Professional ethics and codes of conduct (e.g., fairness, honesty, integrity)
- Diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI)

- Workplace bias and discrimination
- Responsibilities of team members and whistleblowing
- Transparency and merit-based hiring

Questions:

I. Which professional ethical principles were violated or ignored during the hiring process? Support your answer with reference to common codes of conduct (e.g., ACM, IEEE, or local organization standards).

II. How does this case reflect issues of equity, diversity, and inclusion in workplace decision-making?

III. What should the team members who disagreed with the decision have done, according to ethical principles?

IV. What risks (legal, social, or organizational) could the company face as a result of this biased decision-making?

V. If you were part of this hiring committee, how would you apply ethics and fairness to ensure a more inclusive and responsible outcome?

Chapter : 8 Security Governance **[Marks: 15]**

9. **Scenario-Based Assignment:**

You've been appointed as the **Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)** of a futuristic digital company named **FutureLink Corp**, which operates in multiple countries and handles massive amounts of customer data, AI services, and cloud infrastructure.

The company has no formal IT security governance, lacks board-level visibility into risks, has failed past audits, and operates without clear employee policies.

Your Mission:

Create a **Security Leadership Portfolio** that demonstrates your ability to lead secure, compliant, and well-governed operations across the enterprise.

Assignment Components:

1. Design a Security Governance Framework (300–400 words)

Define a **governance model** that answers:

- What is security governance and why is it vital?
- What roles (Board, CISO, IT Team, Employees) are responsible?
- What framework (e.g., NIST, ISO 27001) will guide policies and practices?
- How will you measure success (metrics, audits, outcomes)?

2. Draft a Board Brief: Executive Cybersecurity Snapshot (1 slide or 200-word memo)

Prepare a visual **board-level summary or a written memo** that:

- Outlines current risks and why they matter to the business
- Shows how governance and compliance add value (not just cost)
- Lists top 3 priorities with expected outcomes

3. IT Compliance Playbook (Table or Checklist)

Create a simplified compliance chart for:

- 4–5 applicable laws or standards (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA, SOX)
- How the company can meet each
- Who is responsible and how often audits/checks occur

Standard	Focus Area	Compliance Action	Owner	Frequency

4. Create a Managerial Policy Draft (500–600 words)

Write a **policy document** titled:

"Future Link Information Security & Acceptable Use Policy"

It should include:

- Purpose and scope
- Rules for system, device, and internet use
- Remote work and data protection measures
- Reporting breaches
- Consequences for violations

Section 1: Preparation of Report

Report Must Include:

- Cover Page with College, Program, Assignment Title, Instructor Name, Student Name, Date

Project Documentation

Texas College of Management & IT

Bachelor of Information Technology (BIT)

Project Title: ……

Submitted By:

Name: _____

LCID: _____

Semester: ……

Submitted To:

Instructor Name: _____

Course: ……

Date of Submission: _____

- Table of Contents (auto-generated)
- Executive Summary (~250 words)
- Chapter-wise task responses with proper sub-headings
- Conclusion (~150 words)
- References in APA 7th / IEEE format
- Appendices: raw data, screenshots, designs, policies, code

Section 2: Presentation (if required by instructor)

- Cover Slide with Title, Student Details, Date
- Slide topics per chapter focus
- Visuals and summary points
- Conclusion and References
- Q&A Interaction Readiness

Assignment Structure

Document Format:

- Title Page
- Table of Contents
- Main Body: Introduction, Tasks, Conclusion
- References

Formatting Standards:

- Font: Times New Roman, Size 12
- Line Spacing: 1.5
- Margins: 1 inch on all sides
- Page Numbers: Bottom-right corner
- Diagrams: Include figure numbers and captions

File Naming Convention:
[YourName_DigitalEthicsPortfolio.pdf]

Supplementary Files:
Attach diagrams, figures, flyers, screenshots as separate files if needed

Evaluation and Marking Scheme

A. Written Report – 90%

Criteria	**Weight**
Depth & Accuracy of Analysis	40%

Practical Problem Solving / Creativity	25%
Use of Evidence & Citation	15%
Presentation & Professionalism	10%
Timely Submission	10%

Declaration of Originality:

I hereby declare that this assignment is my original work, and I have referenced all sources as required. I understand that failure to adhere to academic integrity will result in disciplinary action.

Student Name: [Name]
Student ID: [ID]
Signature: [Signature]
Date: [Date]